
```
oLightSwitch = LightSwitch()
```

This says: find the `LightSwitch` class, create a `LightSwitch` object from that class, and assign the resulting object to the variable `oLightSwitch`.

NOTE

As a naming convention in this book, I will generally use the prefix of a lowercase o to denote a variable that represents an object. This is not required, but it's a way to remind myself that the variable represents an object.

Another word that you'll come across in OOP is *instance*. The words *instance* and *object* are essentially interchangeable; however, to be precise, we would say that a `LightSwitch` object is an instance of the `LightSwitch` class.

instantiation

The process of creating an object from a class.

In the previous assignment statement, we went through the instantiation process to create a `LightSwitch` object from the `LightSwitch` class. We can also use this as a verb; we *instantiate* a `LightSwitch` object from the `LightSwitch` class.

Writing a Class in Python

Let's discuss the different parts of a class and the details of instantiating and using an object. [Listing 2-2](#) shows the general form of a class in Python.

```
class <ClassName>():

    def __init__(self, <optional param1>, ..., <optional paramN>):
        # any initialization code here

    # Any number of functions that access the data
    # Each has the form:

    def <functionName1>(self, <optional param1>, ..., <optional paramN>):
```